Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Main Idea & Supporting Details | Practice Quiz

Part A - Find the Main Idea (4 questions)

Directions: Read each paragraph. Underline the sentence that states the main idea. Then circle the best answer.

1. Many animals have special ways to survive in cold places. Polar bears have thick fur and a layer of fat that keep them warm. Arctic foxes grow white winter coats that help them blend into snow. Some birds fly to warmer areas when temperatures drop.

The main idea is:

1) All birds fly south every winter.
2) Animals use different methods to survive cold weather.
3) Polar bears are the only animals that live in cold places.

2. On Saturday, the neighbors worked together to improve their park. One family collected litter near the playground. Several children planted flowers beside the walking path. Others painted old benches so visitors could sit comfortably. By evening, the park looked cleaner and more welcoming.

The main idea is:

1) The neighbors worked together to make their park better.
2) The children wanted to build a new playground.
3) Painting benches is the most important park activity.

3. Some materials can be used again instead of being thrown away. Glass jars can hold pencils or buttons. Old shirts can become cleaning cloths. Cardboard boxes can be turned into storage containers. Reusing things helps reduce waste.

The main idea is:

1) Glass jars are better than cardboard boxes.
2) Old shirts should always be thrown away.
3) Everyday objects can be reused in useful ways.

4. Maya was determined to improve at playing the violin. She practiced difficult songs for twenty minutes each afternoon. When she made mistakes, she slowed down and tried again. After several weeks, she could play a piece that had once seemed impossible.

The main idea is:

1) Maya preferred practicing in the morning.
2) Regular practice helped Maya become a better violinist.
3) The violin is the easiest instrument to learn.

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Main Idea & Supporting Details | Continued

Part B - Underline Main Idea and Details (2 questions)

Directions: Underline the main idea sentence once. Underline THREE supporting detail sentences twice. Then write the main idea in your own words.

5. The School Garden

A school garden can teach students many useful skills. Students learn how plants grow by watching seeds sprout and leaves develop. They practice responsibility by watering seedlings and removing weeds. Working together to care for the garden also teaches cooperation. At harvest time, students can see the results of their patience and hard work.

Main idea in your own words: _____

_____

6. Preparing for a Storm

Families can take several steps to prepare for a strong storm. Keeping flashlights and spare batteries in a safe place is helpful if the power goes out. Storing drinking water and food that does not need cooking is also wise. Families should decide where to meet if they become separated. Preparing ahead of time can make an emergency less frightening.

Main idea in your own words: _____

_____

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Part C - Main Idea Graphic Organizers

Directions: Read each passage. Complete the organizer with ONE main idea and THREE supporting details. Write short, complete ideas in each box.

7. A Busy Library

The town library offers much more than books. Children can listen to stories during weekly reading sessions. Visitors can use computers to research school projects. Families can attend craft workshops on weekends. The library also lends puzzles and educational games.

MAIN IDEA

Supporting Detail 1	**Supporting Detail 2**	**Supporting Detail 3**

8. Protecting Sea Turtles

People can help protect sea turtles in several ways. Volunteers clean plastic and other litter from beaches. Coastal communities can reduce bright lights near nesting areas so hatchlings can find the ocean. Fishing crews can use special equipment that helps turtles escape nets. These actions make beaches and oceans safer for sea turtles.

MAIN IDEA

Supporting Detail 1	**Supporting Detail 2**	**Supporting Detail 3**

Answer Key | Main Idea Practice Quiz

Part A

1. Choice **2** — Animals use different methods to survive cold weather.

2. Choice **1** — The neighbors worked together to make their park better.

3. Choice **3** — Everyday objects can be reused in useful ways.

4. Choice **2** — Regular practice helped Maya become a better violinist.

Part B

5. Main idea: A school garden can teach students many useful skills.
Supporting details: Students learn how plants grow; practice responsibility through garden care; learn cooperation by working together.

6. Main idea: Families can take several steps to prepare for a strong storm.
Supporting details: Keep flashlights and batteries; store water and ready-to-eat food; decide on a family meeting place.

Part C (sample answers; equivalent responses are acceptable)

7. Main idea: The library offers services and activities beyond lending books.
Details: Story sessions for children; computers for research; craft workshops. (Lending puzzles and games is also acceptable.)

8. Main idea: People can help protect sea turtles in several ways.
Details: Remove beach litter; reduce lights near nesting sites; use fishing equipment that lets turtles escape.